Danish for Handball

Samuel's phrasebook: court, training and team life in Denmark

Pronunciation hints are approximate (English-based). Danish swallows word endings and has a soft "r", so listening matters more than spelling. Danes switch to English quickly, so Samuel should say "Du må gerne tale dansk til mig" ("You may speak Danish to me") early on.

Week 1 priority order

Sections 7 (coach shouts) → 3 (positions) → 4 (game actions) → 1 (essentials) → 9 (logistics). Sections 5 and 6 follow once he recognises the coach's rhythm. Coaches speak in short fragments, so the commands and positions cover about 80% of what he will hear in practice.

1. Survival essentials

Danish	English
Hej / Hej hej	Hi / Bye (say "hai" / "hai hai")
Godmorgen / Godaften / Godnat	Good morning / evening / night
Vi ses	See you ("vee sayss")
Tak / Mange tak	Thanks / Thanks a lot ("tahk")
Selv tak / Det var så lidt	You're welcome
Undskyld	Sorry / Excuse me ("ON-skewl")
Ja / Nej / Måske	Yes / No / Maybe
Jeg hedder Samuel	My name is Samuel
Hvad hedder du?	What's your name?
Jeg forstår ikke	I don't understand
Kan du sige det igen?	Can you say that again?
Kan du tale langsommere?	Can you speak slower?
Hvad betyder det?	What does that mean?
Hvordan siger man ... på dansk?	How do you say ... in Danish?
Taler du engelsk?	Do you speak English?
Du må gerne tale dansk til mig	You may speak Danish to me
Jeg lærer dansk	I'm learning Danish
Hvor er ...?	Where is ...?
Hvornår? / Hvad tid?	When? / What time?
Hvordan går det? / Det går fint	How's it going? / Going well
Jeg er træt / sulten / tørstig	I'm tired / hungry / thirsty
Det er okay / Det er fint	It's fine
Pyt!	Never mind / shake it off ("pewt")
Held og lykke	Good luck
Tillykke	Congratulations
Godt gået! / Flot!	Well done! / Nice!

2. Numbers (jersey numbers, scores, times)

#	Danish	#	Danish
1	**en / et**	11	**elleve**
2	**to**	12	**tolv**
3	**tre**	13	**tretten**
4	**fire**	14	**fjorten**
5	**fem**	15	**femten**
6	**seks**	16	**seksten**
7	**syv**	17	**sytten**
8	**otte**	18	**atten**
9	**ni**	19	**nitten**
10	**ti**	20	**tyve**

Days: mandag, tirsdag, onsdag, torsdag, fredag, lørdag, søndag.
Time words: i dag (today), i morgen (tomorrow), i går (yesterday), i aften (tonight).

3. Positions & roles

Danish	English
Målmand	Goalkeeper
Venstre fløj / Højre fløj	Left / Right wing
Venstre back / Højre back	Left / Right back
Playmaker / Midterback	Centre back
Streg / Stregspiller	Pivot / Line player
Bagspiller	Backcourt player
Kaptajn	Captain
Træner / Assistenttræner	Coach / Assistant coach
Holdkammerat	Teammate
Dommer	Referee
Sekretær / Tidtager	Table official / Timekeeper

4. Game actions

Danish	English
Bold	Ball
Aflevering / Aflever!	Pass / Pass it!
Skud / Skyd!	Shot / Shoot!
Mål!	Goal!
Redning	Save
Straffekast	7m penalty

Danish	English
Frikast	Free throw
Indkast	Throw-in (from sideline)
Udkast	Goalkeeper's throw-out
Kontra / Hurtigt angreb	Fast break
1. bølge / 2. bølge	First / second wave
Gennembrud	Breakthrough
Spring skud	Jump shot
Finte / Lav en finte	Fake / Make a fake
Skærm / Sæt skærm	Screen / Set a screen
Skift / Kryds	Switch / Cross (crossing movement)
Blok / Blokering	Block
Erobring	Steal / Ball win
Tabt bold	Turnover
Teknisk fejl	Technical fault
Skridt	Travelling (steps)
Dobbeltdribling	Double dribble
Fejl	Mistake / Foul
Passivt spil	Passive play
Forvarsel	Passive play warning (raised arm)
Overtal / Undertal	Power play / Short-handed
Syv mod seks	7v6 (empty goal)
Tomt mål	Empty net
Tilbage! / Hjem!	Get back! (defensive transition)

5. Systems & tactics

Danish	English
Angreb / Forsvar	Attack / Defence
Opstilling	Formation / Set-up
6-0 (seks-nul)	6:0 defence
5-1 (fem-et)	5:1 defence
3-2-1 (tre-to-en)	3:2:1 defence
Mand-mand	Man-to-man
Offensivt / Defensivt	Aggressive / Passive (defence)
Dæk op / Dæk ud	Step up / Step out on the shooter
Luk hullet	Close the gap
Pres	Press
Hold afstand	Keep distance

Danish	English
Tag din mand	Take your man
Hjælp! / Hjælpeforsvar	Help! / Help defence
Spil på stregen	Play to the pivot
Spil ud på fløjen	Play out to the wing
Gå i dybden	Penetrate / Go deep
Vær tålmodig	Be patient
Hold bolden	Keep possession
Sæt tempoet op / ned	Raise / Lower the tempo

6. Referee, cards & rules

Danish	English
Udvisning (2 min)	2-minute suspension
Gult kort	Yellow card
Rødt kort	Red card
Blåt kort	Blue card (report)
Time-out / Holdtimeout	Team time-out
Straffekast til ...	Penalty to ...
Offensiv fejl	Offensive foul
Overtrædelse	Violation
Udskiftning / Skiftezone	Substitution / Substitution area
Halvleg / Pause	Half / Half-time
Forlænget spilletid	Extra time
Slutresultat	Final score

7. Coach & on-court shouts

Danish	English
Hovedet op!	Heads up!
Kom nu!	Come on!
Sådan!	That's it!
Godt arbejde!	Good work!
Hold fast!	Hold on! / Stay focused!
Fokus!	Focus!
Tal sammen!	Talk to each other!
Kommunikér!	Communicate!
Mine! / Min bold!	Mine! / My ball!
Fri!	I'm open!

Danish	English
Her!	Here!
Ud!	Out! (get out / move out)
Ind!	In!
Hurtigere!	Faster!
Rolig!	Calm down! / Easy!
Tid!	Time!
Skift!	Switch! / Sub!
Igen! / Én gang til!	Again! / One more time!
Op på tæerne!	Up on your toes! (be alert)
Flyt fødderne!	Move your feet!
Stå op!	Stand up / Stay big!
Hvorfor?	Why? (coach questioning a decision)
Lyt efter!	Listen!
Stop! / Frys!	Stop! / Freeze!
Samling!	Huddle!

8. Training & practice

Danish	English
Træning	Training
Opvarmning	Warm-up
Udstrækning / Stræk	Stretching
Styrketræning	Strength training
Løb / Løbetræning	Running / Conditioning
Skudtræning	Shooting drill
Øvelse	Drill
To og to / Par	In pairs
Stil jer op i en række	Line up
Hold A / Hold B	Team A / Team B
Veste	Bibs
Kegler	Cones
Bolde	Balls
Pause (2 min)	Break (2 min)
Vand	Water
Harpiks	Resin / Grip wax
Sidste gang	Last time / Last rep
Godt træningspas	Good session

9. Locker room & logistics

Danish	English
Omklædningsrum	Changing room
Hal	Sports hall
Bad	Shower
Trøje	Jersey
Sko	Shoes
Taske	Bag
Kampdag	Match day
Hjemmekamp / Udekamp	Home / Away game
Mødetid	Meeting time
Afgang	Departure
Hvem kører?	Who's driving?
Har du en ekstra ...?	Do you have a spare ...?
Må jeg låne ...?	Can I borrow ...?
Hvornår er næste træning?	When is the next practice?
Jeg kommer for sent	I'll be late
Jeg kan ikke komme	I can't come
Jeg er syg	I'm sick
Hvor er toilettet?	Where's the toilet?

10. Injuries & medical

Danish	English
Jeg er skadet	I'm injured
Jeg har ondt i ...	I have pain in ...
Ankel / Knæ / Skulder	Ankle / Knee / Shoulder
Ryg / Lår / Læg	Back / Thigh / Calf
Finger / Hånd / Håndled	Finger / Hand / Wrist
Albue / Hoved / Nakke	Elbow / Head / Neck
Det gør ondt	It hurts
Jeg har brug for is	I need ice
Jeg skal til læge	I need to see a doctor
Jeg kan ikke spille	I can't play
Jeg kan godt spille	I can play
Fysioterapeut / Fysio	Physiotherapist
Forstuvet / Overstrakt / Brækket	Sprained / Strained / Broken

11. Social & team culture

Danish	English
Hygge	Cosy, convivial togetherness (core Danish concept)
Skål!	Cheers!
Er du med?	Are you coming / in?
Skal vi ...?	Shall we ...?
Hvad skal vi lave?	What are we doing?
God kamp!	Good game!
Det var uheldigt	That was unlucky
Det var fortjent	That was deserved
Vi vandt / Vi tabte / Uafgjort	We won / We lost / Draw
Vi skal nok klare det	We'll manage
Det var en god kamp	That was a good game
Tak for kampen	Thanks for the game (said to opponents)
Tak for i dag	Thanks for today
Jeg glæder mig til ...	I'm looking forward to ...
Lækkert / Fedt	Awesome / Cool
Det er sjovt	That's fun
Du er god	You're good

12. Pronunciation traps

- **Soft D:** the d after vowels is like a soft English "th" in mad, rød, med, blad.
- **Vowels æ, ø, å:** æ ≈ "air" (short), ø ≈ "uh" with rounded lips, å ≈ "aw".
- **Silent endings:** -et and -ede are swallowed, so spillede ("played") sounds like "spell-uh".
- **Stød (glottal catch):** a throat catch that changes meaning (hun "she" vs hund "dog"). Learned by ear.
- **"Jeg":** pronounced "yai".
- **Sentence rhythm:** flat and fast. Learn the commands (section 7) and positions (section 3) first.